

Tab 20



Board of Education Report

[Return to
Order of Business](#)

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Mr. Schmerelson - Celebrating October as Filipino Heritage Month (Res-008-23/24) (Noticed September 12, 2023)

Whereas, Filipinos contributed to the progression of the cultural, intellectual, political, and economic life in the United States and the Los Angeles Unified School District;

Whereas, There are an estimated 4 million Filipino-Americans residing in the United States, making them the second-largest Asian-American population within the country and the third-largest ethnic group in California;

Whereas, Historic Filipinotown is located in Los Angeles and is a central part of The City of Los Angeles with a rich history and culture;

Whereas, 1.6 percent of students in the District identify as Filipino or of Filipino descent;

Whereas, In October 1587, the first Filipinos arrived in the United States in what is now Morro Bay, California;

Whereas, October is the birth month of influential Filipino-American labor leader, Larry Itliong;

Whereas, October was declared Filipino Heritage Month in California and Hawaii in 1988; and

Whereas, The California Department of Education officially recognized October as Filipino Heritage Month in 2006; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Los Angeles Unified School District will declare October 2023 as Filipino Heritage and History Month;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent's office explore the possibility of establishing a lesson plan on the history of Historic Filipinotown and important Filipino figures in Los Angeles as well as creating a dual language program in the Filipino language after a viability study has been completed; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the District will work with all LAUSD schools to accurately and positively celebrate Filipino history and heritage.